



Book	Policy Manual
Section	6000 Finances
Title	Copy of USE OF CREDIT CARDS
Number	po6423
Status	
Adopted	July 23, 2007
Last Revised	June 26, 2017

6423 - **USE OF CREDIT CARDS**

The Board of Education recognizes the value of an efficient method of payment and recordkeeping for certain expenses.

The Board, therefore, authorizes the use of District credit cards. he name of the District shall appear on each District credit card and check related to a credit card account held by the District. A "credit card account" shall include any bank-issued credit card account, store-issued credit card account, financial institution-issued credit card account, financial depository-issued credit card account, affinity credit card account, or any other card account allowing the holder to purchase goods or services on credit or otherwise transact with the account, and any debit or gift card account related to the receipt of grant monies. The term expressly excludes any procurement card account, gasoline or telephone credit card account, or any other card account where merchant category codes are in place as a system of control for use of the account. ~~The authorization, handling and use of credit cards has been established to provide a convenient and efficient means to purchase goods and services from vendors. Credit cards, however, shall not be used in order to circumvent the general purchasing procedures established by State law and Board policy. The Board affirms that credit cards shall only be used in connection with Board approved or school related activities and that only those types of expenses that are for the benefit of the District and serve a valid and proper public purpose shall be paid for by credit card. However, under no circumstances shall credit cards be used for personal purchases or the purchase of alcoholic beverages regardless of whether the purchase of such beverages is made in connection with a meal.~~

The authorization, handling and use of credit cards has been established to provide a convenient and efficient means to purchase goods and services from vendors. Credit cards, however, shall not be used in order to circumvent the general purchasing procedures established by State law and Board policy. The Board affirms that credit cards shall only be used in connection with Board-approved or school-related activities and that only those types of expenses that are for the benefit of the District and serve a valid and proper public purpose shall be paid for by credit card. However, under no circumstances shall credit cards be used for personal purchases or the purchase of alcoholic beverages regardless of whether the purchase of such beverages is made in connection with a meal. Use of credit cards in an unauthorized or illegal manner may result in revocation of credit card privileges, disciplinary action and/or, where appropriate, may require the user to pay any and all inappropriate charges, including finance charges and interest assessed in connection with the purchase. Additionally, any officer or employee of the District who knowingly misuses a credit card account is guilty of the criminal offense of misuse of credit cards. Violations will be reported to the appropriate law enforcement authorities and any applicable licensure board(s).

[X] Subject to the discretion of the Board and the approval of the Treasurer, credit cards may be used for eligible goods and services including:

1. **(X)** transportation reservations and expenses;
2. **(X)** conference registrations;
3. **(X)** hotel reservation guarantees and expenses;
4. **(X)** reasonable meal expenses (both in-town and out-of-town), including a maximum gratuity of twenty percent (20%), but excluding alcoholic beverages;
5. **(X)** purchases from vendors who do not accept purchase orders or vouchers, with prior approval from Superintendent;
6. **(X)** safety and security reasons in connection with a student field trip, competition, and/or other activity or event, if monies are budgeted and deposited with the Treasurer in advance;

Officers and employees are liable in person and upon official bond for any unauthorized use of credit cards and any officer or employee who suspects the loss, theft, or possibility of unauthorized use of a credit card must notify the Treasurer immediately, who shall notify the Board.

The Board prohibits the use of debit card accounts except for the receipt of grant monies. Any officer or employee of the District who uses a debit card account for any other purpose is guilty of the criminal offense of misuse of credit cards.

Use of the District credit card for any cash withdrawal transaction is strictly prohibited.

The Superintendent shall retain general possession and control of the credit card account or presentation instruments related to an account, such as credit cards and checks. Accordingly, the Board shall appoint the Superintendent to serve as the credit card compliance officer. The compliance officer shall review officers' and employees' use of credit card accounts under the policy at least once every six (6) months. The review shall identify the number of cards issued, the number of active cards issued, the cards' expiration dates, and the cards' credit limits. The compliance officer may not authorize an employee to use a credit card account.

[X] The Treasurer/CFO shall review the credit card account transaction detail monthly and shall sign a written attestation confirming the review.

The Treasurer/CFO shall develop administrative guidelines that specify those employees authorized to use credit cards, the types of expenses which can be paid by credit card, and their proper supervision and use. Inappropriate or illegal use of the credit card and/or failure to strictly comply with the limitations and requirements set forth in the administrative guidelines may result in a loss of credit card privileges, disciplinary action, up to and including termination, personal responsibility for any and all inappropriate charges, including finance charges and interest assessed in connection with the purchase, and/or possible referral to law enforcement authorities for prosecution. Violations will also be reported to the applicable licensure board(s).

The Board authorizes the following employees to use District credit cards:

- A. Superintendent
- B. Treasurer/CFO
- C. Food Service Director
- D. Director of Curriculum

Each request for use of a District credit card shall contain:

1. () date needed,
2. () date to be returned,
3. () purpose,
4. **1. (X)** authorization,

Upon receipt of a District credit card, employees shall:

- 1.
2. **1. (X)** maintain credit cards in a secure fashion and prevent unauthorized charges to the account;
3. **2. (X)** use reasonable care when making purchases online, refrain from providing the credit card number to unknown online merchants, and do not auto-save credit card number for any online account;

~~The Board directs the Treasurer/CFO to determine and specify those employees authorized to use District credit cards. The Treasurer/CFO shall be responsible for giving direction to and supervising such employees' use of District credit cards.~~

The Treasurer/CFO shall file a report with the Board annually, detailing all rewards received based on the use of District's credit card account.

© Neola ~~2018~~**2017**

Last Modified by Jean Kulik on October 24, 2018